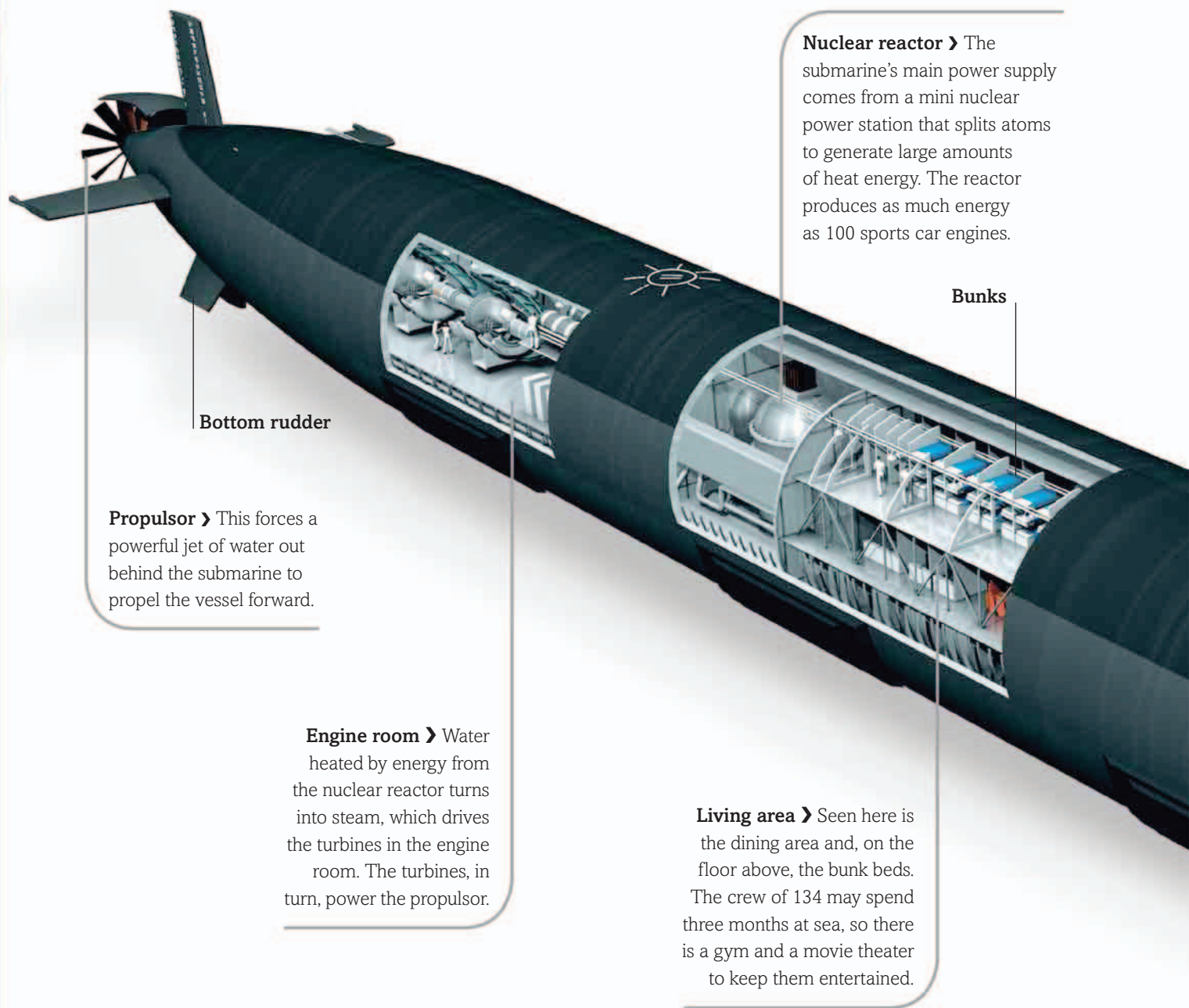




Bottom rudder

Propulsor › This forces a powerful jet of water out behind the submarine to propel the vessel forward.

Engine room › Water heated by energy from the nuclear reactor turns into steam, which drives the turbines in the engine room. The turbines, in turn, power the propulsor.

Nuclear reactor › The submarine's main power supply comes from a mini nuclear power station that splits atoms to generate large amounts of heat energy. The reactor produces as much energy as 100 sports car engines.

Bunks

Living area › Seen here is the dining area and, on the floor above, the bunk beds. The crew of 134 may spend three months at sea, so there is a gym and a movie theater to keep them entertained.

Submarine

Submarines can adjust their buoyancy (how much they can float or sink) using large ballast tanks that can be filled with air or seawater. These tanks allow submarines to dive deep below sea level, cruise stealthily underwater, or rise to the surface. The 377-ft- (115-m-) long **Virginia class submarine** serves in the US Navy. Packed with advanced systems, each submarine took around nine million working hours to build.